Rodrigues, Mauritius

An island that loses its grid, its ship, and its plane in the same storm: stock it, power its water, and seal every drum before December.

AREA	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Rodrigues Regional Assembly (43,604 people)	None published for Mauritius	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (no figure)	Water deficit, dengue; cyclone isolation

17/17 recommendations checked. 12 corrected, 1 unverified, 4 contraindicated (two *Do not* items and two dropped proposals); none confirmed without correction. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review), which publishes no figure for Mauritius; none is scaled here. Verification cut the funding target 25%, under the one-third change the method flags. The 14 October audit then moved the trigger cash to the national line MU-F01; that transfer, not a cut, is most of the fall to US$102,217.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



19.72°S 63.42°E · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Every major cyclone since 2003 has taken out the grid, and the water and the sea link with it.
- **First action.** Ready the one hospital to treat severe dengue and leptospirosis on-island by 30 November.
- **The money.** Floor MUR 3.12m (US$64,800), target 4.92m (US$102,217), ceiling 6.72m (US$139,635).
- **Do not.** No relief plan that waits for a ship or a plane after the warning.

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THE PREMISE — READ FIRST

Rodrigues lies about 560 km east of Mauritius, with its own Regional Assembly (the RRA) and water utility (the Rodrigues Public Utilities Corporation, RPUC). It produces about 4,800 m³ of water a day against demand of about 12,000 m³ [1]. The water shortage of early 2026 came

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

before this El Niño: Mourouk reservoir output fell 50% in February, in a neutral-to-La Niña season [2][3]. El Niño is now strong (ONI +2.16 for July–September 2026) [3], but no source ties it to Rodrigues rainfall; the MMS bulletin of 10 August 2026 gives October–December rain about 92% of normal (near-normal to slightly dry), warmer than normal [48]. So the season's hazards are a chronic deficit that rationing turns into stored water, mosquito-borne disease, and cyclones. A cyclone here cuts the grid, the sea link, and the air link at once. Fuel oil makes 93% of the island's electricity, and the water plants run on that grid [4]. With no published figure, our judgement is that expected deaths among 43,604 people (Census 2022) are in single digits, mostly from severe disease recognised too late.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Ready the island's one hospital to recognise and treat severe dengue and leptospirosis without evacuation

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA Health Commission, with the Ministry of Health; Queen Elizabeth Hospital, Crève Coeur	30 Nov 2026	US$15,000 (MUR 0.72m), mostly assumed	Deaths from late recognition in older and chronically ill patients

Triage fever against the WHO dengue warning signs and give careful fluids. Give empiric antibiotics for fever after flooding, as standard care for leptospirosis. Pre-position NS1/IgM dengue tests and leptospirosis tests, and admit patients with diabetes or hypertension at a lower threshold. Diabetes raises the odds of dengue death (OR 1.95) [5]. Human leptospirosis "has never been described" on Rodrigues, a gap the authors put down to missing diagnostics, not absence [6]. On the mainland in 2026 it killed 6 of 21 cases [7]. Pre-agree transfers to Mauritius, but plan to stabilise patients on the island. No intensive care unit on Rodrigues was found, and the CT scanner has been out since November 2023 [8]. Medical transfers ride scheduled ATR flights [9]. The ATR fleet was down to one serviceable aircraft after a hard landing at Rodrigues in February 2026 [10], and cyclones close the airport.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Cochrane review finds no proven mortality benefit from leptospirosis antibiotics, so this is standard care, not a mortality claim [11]. The current WHO fact sheet says early detection "greatly lower[s] fatality rates" without a figure. The diabetes evidence transfers, but no non-communicable disease survey for Rodrigues was found: 12.7% of people are 60 or older, against about 19% nationally [12].

2. Keep water moving when the grid fails: standby power and fuel at Mourouk and the desalination plants, and a truck contract

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RPUC, with CEB Rodrigues	30 Nov 2026	Not costed; within RPUC's budget line	A week with no piped water after a storm

Fit and load-test standby generators, and stock fuel, at the Mourouk pumping and treatment station and at each desalination plant. Contract the private water-truck fleet before the dry months: in February 2026 "des camions privés aident" [2]. The precedent is the island's own solar desalination plant (80 m³/day on solar, 300 m³/day from the grid at night). It "resumed operation just a few hours after" Cyclone Joaninha, while the grid took weeks [13].*

That plant is 380 m³/day against a deficit of thousands, so it proves the principle, not the scale. Desalination now gives about 3,000 m³/day, with "technical problems" persisting. Whether the Pointe-Coton expansion is running could not be confirmed; ask RPUC [2][14].

3. Seal and chlorinate every stored-water drum, and clear tyres and containers, from November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA Health Commission, with RPUC and parish volunteers	Start 1 Nov; weekly to Mar 2027	MUR 2.03m (US$42,217) for 3,000 households; MUR 3.83m (US$79,634) at the ceiling; lid cost assumed	Dengue breeding and diarrhoea from the same drum

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The water deficit and dengue are one exposure, the uncovered drum. Give fitted lids, mesh, and chlorine tablets to the 3,000 poorest households, and have parish volunteers check drums and tip out containers on Saturdays. Rodrigues had 1,363 dengue cases between December 2023 and March 2024 [15]. Household chlorination cut diarrhoea by about a quarter in the Cochrane review (RR 0.77, low-quality evidence) [16]. During water rationing on Mayotte, sentinel-doctor visits for acute diarrhoea were 10.1% of consultations against 5.7% elsewhere [17]. Chlorine tablets cost about US$0.40 a household a month [18]. The lid kit (a lid or cover, mesh, and larvicide where safe) is costed at Rs 600 a household, the figure used across the Mauritius set. It is an assumption with no Mauritian quote, so money is released only against a written supplier quote.*

Transferability is partial. The mortality trials behind water treatment come from low-income countries with high child mortality. Rodrigues has about nine under-five deaths a year, so expect fewer cases, not saved lives [19]. No water-linked diarrhoea outbreak on Rodrigues was found. A standing RPUC tanker service could not be confirmed, so plan to distribute through parishes and schools. Six lenses converged here, partly on the same canonical trials. The local case rests on the 2023–24 dengue count and the rationing itself.

4. Stock the island before December: food, fuel, LPG, chlorine, and medicines ashore by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD · EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA, with the Mauritius Shipping Corporation, STC, and fuel importer AEL DDS	**30 Nov 2026**	**One extra rotation plus carrying cost; not costed**	**Empty shelves and a dark grid while the ship cannot dock**

Schedule an extra November cargo rotation and hold staples, chlorine, and medicines ashore. Lift fuel and LPG above the existing strategic stock of about 30 days: AEL DDS storage was raised to 1.115m litres, and shortages still recur [20]. Agree now that the *Mauritius Trochetia* (built 2001) replaces the cargo ship *Peros Banhos* (250–270 containers) within 72 hours if it breaks down. Both ships also carry the power station's heavy fuel oil, and the crossing now takes 32 hours [21]. During Cyclone Dudzai in January 2026 the *Trochetia* waited off Mauritius, and every Rodrigues flight was cancelled [22].

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No STC depot or stock on Rodrigues was found, and no evidence that pre-season stocking is routine. Count food security in sailings of cover ashore, not tonnes in Port Louis.

5. Get every boat and foot fisher off the water before the storm: a boat register, report-in at Class I, and landing-site warnings

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA Fisheries Commission, with Police and the National Coast Guard, Shoals Rodrigues, and fishers' cooperatives	1 Dec 2026	Staff and volunteer time	Fishers lost at sea in a storm that misses the island

Cyclone Dina (January 2002) passed about 150 km north with no direct hit. Five Rodrigues fishermen were reported missing at sea [23]. Keep a register of boats that must report in at Class I, put tide, wind, and warning boards at each landing site, and run a phone tree through the cooperatives. Include the women who fish the lagoon flats on foot [24]. Register uncarded fishers so that any bad-weather allowance can reach them: nationally it pays Rs 800 a day to about 2,506 registered fishers, and uncarded fishers get nothing [25].

The Dina deaths rest on secondary sources (Météo-France as cited by Wikipedia, and a Réunion outlet); read them as "missing, presumed dead". Class I bulletins already advise against going to sea, and fishers hauled out their pirogues unprompted for Horacio in February 2026 [26]. No legal basis for closing the sea at Class II was found. Whether the allowance applies on Rodrigues, and to foot fishers, is unverified.

6. Equip every refuge centre for 500 people: three days of water, power, a satellite phone, and bed nets

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA (disaster management) and the local DRRM committee	30 Nov 2026	US$45,000 (MUR 2.16m), assumed	Evacuees cut off without water, power, or a line out

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

After Cyclone Joaninha (March 2019), 471 people sheltered in emergency centres, the whole grid went down, and recovery took weeks [27]. Size each centre's water, power, and communications for a repeat, and put bed nets and covered water storage in each so the refuge is not a breeding site.

No current inventory of refuge-centre equipment was found, so the first step is a count. The site count and unit cost are assumptions.

7. Through the parishes, list everyone who is old, bedbound, or alone, and check on them within 12 hours of a warning or a water cut

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Apostolic Vicariate of Rodrigues and its parishes, with the Red Cross Rodrigues branch	Lists by 1 Dec 2026	Volunteer time	People found too late in hill villages

About 91% of Rodriguans are Catholic, and Sunday Mass is the one gathering that reaches the hill villages [28]. Each chapel names two volunteers per hamlet, starting with Grande Montagne, Mont Lubin, and La Ferme. They keep the list and give two-line announcements in Kreol after Mass, December to March. In 2025 the RRA was in open political conflict, so a message from the priest or a neighbour is less likely to be read as party politics [29]. Living alone and not leaving home daily were the strongest predictors of death in the Chicago heat wave of 1995 [30].

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The evidence links isolation to death; no trial shows that check-ins prevent it. The Red Cross branch was active in school disaster-risk work in 2024 [31], but its current membership is unknown; "30 trained members" dates from 2016.

8. Write the March 2026 rain relief into the national cash rule before the season, so it is released on a Rodrigues warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Social Integration (NSF and NEF), with the RRA	Agreed by 30 Nov 2026; paid on trigger	Draws on the national line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8m cap per trigger); not counted here	Harm, not deaths: three weeks of waiting after a storm

After the torrential rain of 15 March 2026, Rs 2.795m was announced on 4 April, about three weeks later [32]. The NEF paid Rs 795k of it (Rs 15,000 to 16 households, and Rs 5,000 to 62 households and 49 students). The NSF paid Rs 2m to 200 families, at Rs 5,000–8,000 by household size. It is the largest comparable payout on record. The set now carries one national rule for this (MU-F01): Rs 5,000 a Social Register household per trigger, capped at Rs 2.8m, paid by the NEF with the NSF on an MMS Class II cyclone or heavy-rain warning. Agree now that a Rodrigues warning fires it, and that the April 2026 recipients head the Rodrigues priority list. Then the money moves on the warning, not on a photograph.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Rodrigues has its own warnings, but a Rodrigues-only warning draws on the same Rs 2.8m cap as the main island, and the NEF allocates at the trigger, so a main-island warning in the same week could take most of it. A port closure of more than five days is not in the national trigger; ask for it as a Rodrigues addition. Extending the NSF to Rodrigues was still "under discussion" in November 2025 [33], and no count of Social Register households on Rodrigues was found.

9. Restock the Red Cross warehouse on Rodrigues and prepare a DREF request for a Class II warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Mauritius Red Cross Society (Rodrigues branch), with PIROI and the IFRC	30 Nov 2026	Not costed	Relief stock stuck in Port Louis

The pre-positioning warehouse on Rodrigues was built in 2016–17 with AUD 60,000 because emergency stocks were limited "faute de capacité de stockage". It supplied camp beds during Joaninha in 2019 [34]. The IFRC's 2026 plan restocks the headquarters warehouse but names no Rodrigues stock and no Early Action Protocol [35]. A DREF imminent-crisis request is the realistic route this season, and its release is discretionary.

No current stock figures for Rodrigues were found.

10. Fund lidded household rainwater tanks from the RRA's own water line, not the main-island grant

UNVERIFIED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NO MAURITIUS ENTRY

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
RRA, with RPUC	Call open by 30 Nov 2026	RRA's own line, rate to be set (within its Rs 216.3m 2025–26 utility and rainwater line); not counted here	Open drums as the household's buffer

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The RRA's 2025–26 budget holds Rs 216.3m for RPUC and rainwater harvesting [36]. Use part of it for household tanks with a sealed lid and screened inlet as a condition of payment. Proposing the national Water Tank and Pump Grant was dropped: the CWA and DBM run it on the main island. On 9 October 2026 Cabinet widened it to a Rs 15,000 voucher for every household without a tank [47], and nothing found shows that it reaches Rodrigues. Ask the ministry whether it does. If it does, this becomes an enrolment drive with a lid request, as on the main island, at the voucher's Rs 15,000. If it does not, the RRA sets its own rate. This is the briefing's only tank line; the earlier ceiling tranche of tanks at Rs 8,000 is withdrawn.

Unverified: the household breakdown of the RRA line, whether a call can open before December, and the reported EU-funded tanks for 250 families.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Health	RPUC / CEB	RRA	MSCL / STC	Fisheries	Police / NCG	Shoals / coops	Parishes	MRCS	NSF / NEF
1. Hospital readiness	**A/R**		**C**							
2. Water without the grid		**A/R**	**C**							
3. Sealed, chlorinated drums	**A/R**	**R**						**R**		
4. Stock the island	**C**	**C**	**A**	**R**						
5. Boats and foot fishers			**I**		**A/R**	**R**	**R**			
6. Refuge centres	**C**		**A/R**						**C**	
7. Parish check-in lists	**I**							**A/R**	**R**	
8. Pre-agreed cash rule			**C**							**A/R**
9. Red Cross stock and DREF			**C**						**A/R**	
10. Lidded household tanks	**C**	**R**	**A**							

What the chart shows: the RRA is consulted or accountable on seven rows and the health service on six. The highest-ranked work sits with the Health Commission and RPUC. Only actions 1, 3, and 6 need money from this envelope, and action 8 draws on the national cash line MU-F01; the rest need decisions, contracts, and volunteers. Health: RRA Health Commission and Ministry of Health. NCG: National Coast Guard. MSCL: Mauritius Shipping Corporation. MRCS: Mauritius Red Cross Society.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. Rate: US$1 = MUR 48.1061 (MRA customs rate, week of 12–18 Oct 2026) [37].

FLOOR

MUR 3.12m (US$64,800)

TARGET

MUR 4.92m (US$102,217)

CEILING

MUR 6.72m (US$139,635)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Baseline deaths: in our judgement single digits, so lives saved per dollar is low

Floor = clinical readiness US$15,000 + chlorine tablets for 3,000 households, December to March (3,000 × 4 months × US$0.40 = US$4,800) + refuge and health-centre storage US$45,000 = US$64,800 = MUR 3.12m. **Target** = floor + lid kits for the 3,000 poorest households at Rs 600 (Rs 1.8m, US$37,417) = US$102,217 = MUR 4.92m. **Ceiling** = target + lid kits for a further 3,000 households at Rs 600 (Rs 1.8m, US$37,417) =

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

US$139,635 = MUR 6.72m. That puts about 6,000 of an estimated 13,200 households under a lid (43,604 people at an assumed 3.3 a household). It is released only after the first 3,000 are delivered, and against a written supplier quote. **Not counted:** trigger cash, which draws on the national line MU-F01, and household tanks, which are on the RRA's own line at a rate still to be set (action 10). The lens's target was US$206,062. In verification it fell 25%, to US$155,362, for two reasons. A full Camino Verde programme was cut to lids only, because its authors judged it not cost-effective and no 2025–26 dengue transmission was found on Rodrigues. Clinical readiness was added at the top of the ranking. The 14 October audit then made four changes. The cash (US$62,362) moved to MU-F01. Chlorine was separated from the lids, which had been counted in two placements. The lids were repriced at the set-wide Rs 600. The unbacked ceiling (cash raised to Rs 10m, and tanks at a superseded Rs 8,000) was replaced by a second lid tranche. Every amount is our arithmetic from published or assumed unit costs.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
RRA Health Commission (Queen Elizabeth Hospital)	Action 1: 1,000 dengue NS1/IgM tests, 300 leptospirosis tests, fluids, clinician refresher	MUR 0.72m (US$15,000)	Pre-positioned stock	Dengue combo test about US$0.70–3 [38]; the rest assumed. Few deaths, but each is preventable with recognition	UNVERIFIED
RRA Health Commission, via the Social Register	Action 3: chlorine tablets only, for the 3,000 poorest households, Dec–Mar	MUR 0.23m (US$4,800)	Pre-positioned stock	Tablets about US$0.40 a household a month (UNICEF) [18]; delivered by parish volunteers. Mortality effect in Kremer et al. does not transfer [19]	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
RRA (refuges) and the health service	Action 6: water storage and chlorination at about 15 refuges and health centres	MUR 2.16m (US$45,000)	Direct grant	Site count and US$3,000 per site assumed	UNVERIFIED
RRA Health Commission, with parishes	Action 3: lid kits (lid or cover, mesh, larvicide where safe) for the same 3,000 households (target)	MUR 1.8m (US$37,417)	Pre-positioned stock	Rs 600 a household, the set-wide figure; an assumption with no Mauritian quote. Released against a written supplier quote	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
RRA Health Commission, with parishes	Action 3: lid kits for a further 3,000 households (ceiling)	MUR 1.8m (US$37,417)	Pre-positioned stock	Rs 600 a household, as above. Released after the first 3,000 are delivered; household count assumed at 3.3 a household	UNVERIFIED
NEF and NSF (national line MU-F01)	Action 8: trigger-released cash	Not counted in this envelope	Unconditional cash transfer	Draws on the national trigger-cash line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8m cap per trigger, shared by all six zones): **not counted in this envelope**. Precedent: Rs 2.795m after the 15 March 2026 rains [32]	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

The funder's one thing: money here buys speed and targeting, not scale. The water gap is a capital problem that AFD (a €200m loan for 2024–27 shared with Mauritius), the Mauritius Investment Corporation (Rs 540m for desalination), and the RRA are already paying to close [1][36]. Expected deaths are few, so a small sum goes a long way and a large one adds little. Before December, money buys tests at the hospital, sealed drums for the poorest, and refuges that hold water, while the cash rule sits on the national line.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not plan relief that waits for a ship or a plane after the warning

CONTRAINDICATED

In January 2026, during Cyclone Dudzai, the *Trochetia* sailed from Port Louis and then waited off Mauritius, and Air Mauritius cancelled every Rodrigues flight [22]. Weeks later one serviceable ATR was left [10]. Stock held in Port Louis is out of reach exactly when it is needed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: get fuel, chlorine, medicines, and food ashore in November (action 4), and plan for 72 hours with no ship, no plane, and no grid.

Do not count new desalination capacity as supply until it runs, or buy units without an operating budget

CONTRAINDICATED

In January 2026 the Pointe-Coton expansion was due by end-April or early May. By February the date was mid-June and "des problèmes techniques persistent" [14][2]. Its status now is unconfirmed. Capacity that is not running pushes households back to stored water.

Instead: judge water spending by hours of reliable piped supply. Fund operation, parts, fuel, and technicians for the plants that exist, and back them with standby power (action 2).

Do not hand out tanks or drums without sealed lids

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

On Saint-Martin after Hurricanes Irma and Maria in 2017, reserves and drums were 23% of larva-positive sites and 38% of pupa-positive sites [39]. That vector was *Ae. aegypti*, and no larval data exist for Rodrigues. But every water cut here makes households store more, and an open drum kept for weeks breeds mosquitoes.

Instead: make a sealed lid and screened inlet a condition of every tank and drum handed out (actions 3 and 10).

Do not lead dengue control with fogging

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Ae. albopictus in neighbouring Réunion shows metabolic resistance to pyrethroids (preprint, 2025) [40]. A systematic review found no clear evidence for space spraying as a stand-alone measure [41]. Fogging is visible and reassuring, and it does not touch the drum.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: source reduction and container checks at the start of the wet season (action 3). Fog only around confirmed cases.

Do not call this an "El Niño drought"

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

The 2026 shortage came before El Niño: the Mourouk output fall was in a neutral-to-La Niña season (ONI −0.39 in December–February) [2][3]. The deficit is chronic, about 7,000 m³ a day [1], and it long predates this El Niño. Calling it El Niño implies it ends when El Niño does, and it points people away from the cyclone and the mosquito.

Instead: call it a chronic water deficit plus a wet-season dengue and cyclone risk.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Dec 1967 – Mar 1968	Cyclones Carmen and Monique (La Niña)	3,500 homeless, 24 injured, ~US$5m; a combined toll, not confirmed as Rodrigues only [42]	Nothing found
1972	Cyclone Fabienne (La Niña fading)	2 dead, 16 injured [42]	Nothing found
Jan 1991	Cyclone Bella, ~50 km west (neutral)	1,200 homes damaged, 300 destroyed, ~1,000 homeless, >90% of crops lost [42]	Nothing found
Jan 2002	Cyclone Dina, ~150 km north (neutral)	5 fishermen reported missing at sea; secondary sources [23]	Nothing found
Mar 2003	Cyclone Kalunde, within 55 km (El Niño decaying)	Island without power; ~US$3.15m damage [43]	Nothing found

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Feb–Jun 2006	Chikungunya (La Niña)	56 cases in March, 393 in April, >80 in May; deaths significantly above expected in May [44]	Vector control rebuilt nationally
Feb–Mar 2019	Cyclones Gelena and Joaninha (weak El Niño)	Gelena: ~90% without power. Joaninha: whole grid down, 471 sheltered, no deaths reported [27]	The solar desalination plant was back within hours [13]
Dec 2023 – Mar 2024	Dengue (strong El Niño)	1,363 cases on Rodrigues and 3,311 on the main island, 4 deaths, to 19 Mar 2024 [15]; then about 7,177 cases and 15 deaths nationally by 28 Apr (secondary) [50]. The government's figure is 6,673 cases and 8 deaths (June 2024)	Nothing found
Jan 2026	Cyclone Dudzai	No damage; ship held, all flights cancelled [22]	Nothing found
Feb 2026	Water shortage (neutral)	Mourouk output −50%; private trucks filled gaps [2]	Pointe-Coton desalination promised for mid-2026
15 Mar 2026	Torrential rain	No deaths; Crève Coeur hospital flooded [45]	Rs 2.795m announced 4 April, about three weeks later [32]
Apr–Aug 2026	Chikungunya, a national epidemic	92 cases on Rodrigues in the 12 July count of 6,675; 6,891 confirmed nationally by 28 August 2026, mostly mid-April to early May [49]	Nothing found

The recurrence nobody has noticed: on Rodrigues the disaster is the power cut, not the wind. Every major cyclone since 2003 (Kalunde, Gelena, Joaninha) has ended in a grid failure, and the water system, the fuel supply, and the clinic all run on that grid. For earlier storms the record has no power data. All three of those storms came in El Niño-phase seasons. That is a handful of events, not a forecast, but it is reason not to read this El Niño as a quiet cyclone year. Most cyclone rows rest on secondary sources (Wikipedia citing Météo-France).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Clinical readiness saves the most lives per dollar** (Public health) versus **water treatment and vector control first** (Philanthropist). Expected deaths are, in our judgement, in single digits, most from late recognition, and the mortality trials behind water treatment come from high-mortality countries. So clinical readiness now ranks first, and the vector programme was cut to lids.
- **Close the sea at Class II and pay fishers to stay ashore** (Emergency manager) versus **no legal basis found, and fishers already haul out** (verification). Fishers hauled out unprompted for Horacio in 2026. The register and landing-site warnings stand; a legal closure needs a basis first.
- **Parametric cover for Rodrigues** was **not recommended** (Economist). An island of 43,600 would pay a premium for heavy basis risk, and Mauritius is outside ARC. A pre-agreed budget rule (action 8) gives the same speed for nothing.
- **Extend the national water-tank grant to Rodrigues** (Economist) was **dropped as framed**: the scheme runs through the CWA and DBM on the main island. Action 10 uses the RRA's own line instead.
- **Rainwater-harvesting rules for new buildings and a rising-block tariff** (Economist) are sound but take effect over years, not before this peak. They are noted, not ranked.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Livestock. Rodrigues sells cattle and goats to Mauritius, and water, not feed, is the herd's constraint. Rodrigues-origin cattle slaughtered on Mauritius fell from 716 head in 2022 to 300 in 2023 [46]. One lens proposed a fodder and water reserve, but no lens measured how many households depend on livestock income or what a dry spell costs them. If that dependence is large, distress sales after a dry spell could hit the same households action 8 is trying to reach. The second gap is data: no current poverty rate (the last is 10.3% in 2006–07), no Social Register count, and no disease surveillance by village were found.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

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Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale. Rodrigues sits in MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed), which also holds the main island outside Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems: about 850,000 people. They are not island figures, and none is published for Mauritius. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was Rodrigues, the whole island, under the Rodrigues Regional Assembly. This is briefing 3 of six in the Mauritius set, which is aligned to the water supply systems. Climate Impact Lab impact region: MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed), decoded from the Impact Map's boundary file. Mauritius has three impact regions, and this one covers the main island outside Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems, plus Rodrigues: about 850,000 people. The study publishes no Mauritius figure. Rodrigues, at 43,604 people (Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius [12]; the map data's WorldPop 2020 estimate is about 45,000), is a small part of that region. Island detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. National facts came from a verified evidence pack (two Storm research briefings and the East and South briefing, all 13 October 2026), which the lenses reused and did not re-research.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Five verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial and food actions were checked together for availability on Rodrigues, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist. The

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funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. The do-not items and the historical record had their own verifier, which read ENSO phases from NOAA's ONI table.

- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not re-queried in this run. The Upper and Lower Mare aux Vacoas briefings, built the same day, read the dataset embedded in the inventory page: 96 entries, none for Mauritius and none on vector control, water rationing, or flash-flood warning. The tags say "no Mauritius entry", which means no matching precedent was found, not that the action is unprecedented.
- **Map data.** Actions, funding, and events are also written as map data beside this file, keyed to the area code `RRA`. No action has a point location.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (dengue warning signs, fluids, and antibiotics, standby generators and fuel, and chlorine tablets for stored water) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one on Rodrigues was interviewed. Most 2026 facts come through Mauritian press (L'Express via AllAfrica). The Météo-France and Réunion prefecture reports on Cyclone Dina could not be opened. Two verifiers read different rainfall totals for 15 March 2026 from the same article, so none is quoted. No Rodrigues poverty figure newer than 2006–07, no Social Register count, and no entomology were found. An earlier draft said the water deficit was "known in 1987"; no source for that date could be traced, so the claim was softened to "long predates this El Niño". Beesoon et al. (2008) was rechecked and does break out Rodrigues: monthly cases, and observed deaths above expected in May ($p<0.01$).
- **Revision.** Revised 2026-10-14 after the set audit (fixes applied: 1 impact region; 2 trigger cash moved to the national line MU-F01; 3 lids at Rs 600 a household; 4 national references on the sidecar; 6 dengue in two stages; 7 chikungunya 2026; 9 MMS forecast; 10 Rodrigues relief wording and population basis; 16–17 envelope rebuilt from real placements, with chlorine separated from the lids; 18 tone; 19 grid failures

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dated from 2003; 20 judgement labels, the 1987 claim, Beesoon, and the one-third flag). Fixes 5 and 8 needed no change here: the rate was already 48.1061, and rationing on the main island is not in this briefing.

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Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026, revised 14 October 2026, for Rodrigues, Mauritius. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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